

ENGLISH GRAMMAR AND COMPOSITION

Class Eight



National Curriculum and Textbook Board, Bangladesh

**Prescribed by the National Curriculum and Textbook Board
as a textbook for class eight from the academic year 2017**

English Grammar and Composition

Class Eight

Revised for the year 2026

Published by
National Curriculum & Textbook Board
69-70, Motijheel Commercial Area, Dhaka

[All rights reserved by the Publisher]

First edition written and edited by

A M N Hamidur Rahman
S M Nazrul Islam
Zulfeqar Haider
Ranjit Podder
Md. Mahmudul Amin
Fatema Zohra Haque

First edition : June, 2016
Revised editon : October, 2024
Revised editon : October, 2025

For Free Distribution by the Government of the People's Republic of Bangladesh

Printed by :

Preface

The importance of formal education is diversified. The prime goal of modern education is not to impart knowledge only but to build a prosperous nation by developing skilled human resources. At the same time, education is the best means of creating a society free from superstitions and adheres to science and facts. To stand as a developed nation in the science and technology-driven world of the 21st century, we need to ensure quality education. A well-planned education is essential for enabling our new generation to face the challenges of the age and to motivate them with the strength of patriotism, values, and ethics. In this context, the government is determined to ensure education according to the demand of the age.

Education is the backbone of a nation and a curriculum provides the essence of formal education. Again, the most important tool for implementing a curriculum is the textbook. The National Curriculum 2012 has been adopted to achieve the goals of the National Education Policy 2010. In light of this, the National Curriculum and Textbook Board (NCTB) has been persistently working on developing, printing, and distributing quality textbooks. This organization also reviews and revises the curriculum, textbook, and assessment methods according to needs and realities.

Secondary education is a vital stage in our education system. This textbook is catered to the age, aptitude, and endless inquisitiveness of the students at this level, as well as to achieve the aims and objectives of the curriculum. It is believed that the book written and meticulously edited by experienced and skilled teachers and experts will be conducive to a joyful experience for the students. It is hoped that the book will play a significant role in promoting creative and aesthetic spirits among students along with subject knowledge and skills.

Communicative grammar is a comparatively new trend in the field of English language teaching. The main difference between conventional and communicative grammar is characterized by the teaching and learning approaches. The traditional grammar book explains the rules and focuses on usage while communicative grammar presents items in contexts and creates opportunities to use the language accurately as well as fluently. Thus, communicative grammar promotes accuracy alongside fluency and helps develop language acquisition. Again, the ‘composition part’ in the book introduces the process approach so that the students can express and organize ideas in writing without memorizing various genres of writing in English. It is hoped that the English Grammar and Composition books for grades VI-X will develop students’ grammatical competence and writing skills.

It may be mentioned here that due to the changing situation in 2024 and as per the needs the textbook has been reviewed and revised for the academic year 2025. Meticulous attention has been paid to the textbook to make it more learner-friendly and error-free. However, any suggestions for further improvement of this book will be appreciated.

Finally, I would like to thank all those who have contributed to the book as writers, editors, reviewers, illustrators, and graphic designers.

October, 2025

Professor Robiul Kabir Chowdhury

Chairman (Additional Charge)

National Curriculum & Textbook Board, Bangladesh

Contents

Part	Unit	Title	Page
Part I Grammar	1	Parts of Speech	1
	2	Modals	53
	3	Articles, linking words and Possessives	70
	4	Degrees of Adjectives	90
	5	Tenses	99
	6	Infinitive, Gerund and Participle	125
	7	Sentences	136
	8	Voice	150
	9	Direct and Indirect Speech	163
	10	Suffixes and Prefixes	176
	11	Capitalisation and Punctuation	180
Part II Composition	▪	Writing process	188
	▪	Letter writing	195
	▪	Writing email	204
	▪	Developing Composition	209